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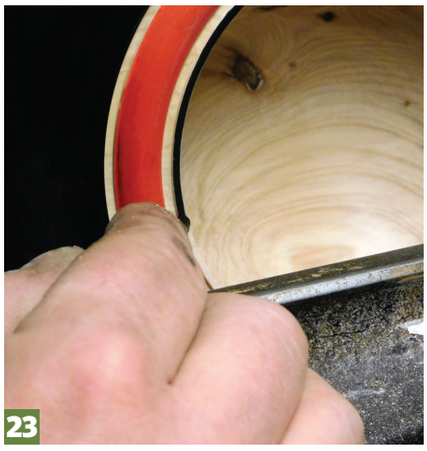
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21 Because the rim section extends over the underlying ogee we need to undercut the rim slightly for two reasons. Firstly, it prevents the lower section of the bowl developing a too heavy wall. Secondly, the undercut bowl adds interest to the finished piece, casting an inner shadow when lit from above. If your lathe has a reverse function and you have a chuck that will lock onto the lathe spindle you might find it easier to form the undercut with the lathe in reverse. This can be an unusual cut the first time you try it, but cutting on the opposite side to usual is easier and enables you to see the shape form

22 Complete the bowl shape, aiming for a flowing uninterrupted curve from rim to base. Undercutting can result in a poorer than usual surface finish because of the change in direction of the cut and the difficulty of achieving it. If this is the case you may need to clean the surface with a round-nose scraper. A round bar scraper is more easily controlled. Keep the cutting edge at about 45º to the wood to provide a shear scrape. Take very light cuts and do not rush. Once satisfied abrade the inner bowl to a 400-grit finish, seal and apply paste wax to a finish

23 In order to harmonise the bowl decoration take a black sharpie – or paint and a brush if you feel confident! – and colour the narrow band you left to the inside of the bead. This frames the bead and gives the whole thing a frame

24 The cadmium red I used is a very strong colour and the effect was a little too clean and bright for my tastes, so I decided on a simple and effective addition. I used a gilding paste to knock back the brightness a little and give an aged appearance. I used Chinese Red as it complemented the cadmium. Apply sparingly and carefully buff once cured. Excess is easily removed with repeated buffing. Once cured the whole upper painted surfaces can be lacquered if a more durable finish is required

25 The bowl is almost complete, but we have the tenon to deal with. Tenons ought not to be left on the objects we make. They are not designed to be there as part of the final piece. They are only for holding material, so we should remove them afterwards. I use a simple neoprene-faced jam chuck with the bowl trapped between it and the revolving cup centre. Take light cuts with a freshly ground 10mm spindle gouge and slightly dish the base. Abrade to a finish and the remove the remaining stud with a carving tool or sharp craft knife. Abrade the last part and seal

26 Sign your name and your new, modern bowl is done ●

ARTISTS' SPRAY PAINTS

Artists' spray paints are now made by a number of companies and are available from good art supplies stores, both on the high street and online. The quality is much improved and they are produced specifically with the 'artist' in mind and differ noticeably from the more usual car-body sprays turners have used previously. You may need to experiment with the water-based and cellulose versions and you may find you prefer one over the other for a given application. The main advantage is the vast colour range, often offered in complementary palette schemes. One thing worth noting is the spray heads; these can be as prone to blocking as any other spray head. So read the instructions, see if the manufacturer has online help videos and follow the instructions. At an average of £10 a can you do not want to find your spray can is unusable later on.

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